

5 Books That Helped Me Become a Millionaire

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 30, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/0qacvFthM8> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter recommends five books that directly contributed to his millionaire journey, spanning business stage strategy, marketing, persuasion principles, sales, and negotiation — each chosen for actionability over theory.

Contents

-  Book 1: Ready Fire Aim by Michael Masterson
-  Book 2: Expert Secrets by Russell Brunson
-  Book 3: Influence by Robert Cialdini
-  Book 4: Pitch Anything
-  Book 5: Never Split the Difference by Chris Voss

Book 1: Ready Fire Aim by Michael Masterson 0:00

- Covers what you need to focus on at **every stage of income**, from \$0 to \$100 million per year
- Core insight: people often focus on the wrong things — not because those things are inherently wrong, but because they're wrong for their current stage of business
- Key takeaway for early-stage entrepreneurs:
 - If you're just starting out, your primary focus must be **sales**
 - Until you're making sales, you have a hobby, not a business

Book 2: Expert Secrets by Russell Brunson 0:23

- Brandon calls this **required reading** for new entrepreneurs
- Stands out from typical marketing books which tend to offer only high-level ideas
 - Expert Secrets tells you **exactly what to do**, making it highly actionable
- Brandon found it personally helpful and broadly recommends it to anyone starting out in business

Book 3: Influence by Robert Cialdini 0:47

- Described as the go-to book for **higher-level marketing principles**
- Key distinction Brandon emphasizes: principles vs. tactics
 - Tactics are always changing and will eventually stop working

- If you only know tactics and never learned the underlying principles, you can't adapt when a tactic fails
- This book gives you **the foundation** — the principles behind why marketing works

Book 4: Pitch Anything 1:09

- Brandon's top recommendation for sales — says it would be difficult to find a better book on the subject
- He has read or listened to it **over 100 times**
- Has told every salesperson he's ever managed that they need to read and study it

"If you do sales in any capacity and you have not read this book, then you, my friend, are hustling backwards."

- His instruction: don't just read it — **study it and apply it**

Book 5: Never Split the Difference by Chris Voss 1:32

- Brandon's top pick for negotiation — says there has never been and may never be a better book on the subject
- He lost his physical copy when moving to Miami but already had it on Kindle
- Author credibility: Chris Voss was an **FBI hostage negotiator** who dealt with terrorists and bank robbers
 - Brandon's logic: if Voss could negotiate in those extreme life-or-death situations, he can certainly teach everyday negotiation skills like getting a raise at work